

Basic Open Chords

Open chords are the foundation of guitar playing. They are called "open" because they use un-fretted (open) strings along with fretted ones.

1. How to Read Finger Numbers

Before placing your fingers, assign each finger on your fretting hand a number:

- **1** = Index Finger
- **2** = Middle Finger
- **3** = Ring Finger
- **4** = Pinky Finger

2. Essential Beginner Chords

E Minor (Em)

One of the easiest chords to learn first.

- **Middle Finger (2):** 5th string, 2nd fret
- **Ring Finger (3):** 4th string, 2nd fret
- **Strum:** All 6 strings

A Minor (Am)

- **Index Finger (1):** 2nd string, 1st fret
- **Middle Finger (2):** 4th string, 2nd fret
- **Ring Finger (3):** 3rd string, 2nd fret
- **Strum:** Bottom 5 strings (skip the thick 6th E string)

C Major (C)

- **Index Finger (1):** 2nd string, 1st fret
- **Middle Finger (2):** 4th string, 2nd fret
- **Ring Finger (3):** 5th string, 3rd fret
- **Strum:** Bottom 5 strings

G Major (G)

- **Middle Finger (2):** 5th string, 2nd fret
- **Ring Finger (3):** 6th string, 3rd fret
- **Pinky Finger (4):** 1st string, 3rd fret
- **Strum:** All 6 strings

D Major (D)

- **Index Finger (1):** 3rd string, 2nd fret
- **Middle Finger (2):** 1st string, 2nd fret
- **Ring Finger (3):** 2nd string, 3rd fret
- **Strum:** Bottom 4 strings (strings 4, 3, 2, and 1)